

Ask any successful entrepreneur and they will validate this truth: You learn from engagement, from doing, and from getting out and taking repeated action, more so than from any book or professor.

But “I don’t know how!” you cry. Oh, stop. Public enemy No. 1 on the most-used excuses list is, “I don’t know how!” Well, why don’t you know how? I’ll tell you why. You don’t know because you haven’t taught yourself how, nor have you wanted to “know how” badly enough. You see, it is easier to relent under the weight of “I don’t know how” than it is to actively pursue the knowledge. In today’s information society, *there is absolutely no excuse not to find out how.*

I graduated from college with two business degrees, marketing and finance. Neither of them was related to computer science. I graduated with no computer programming experience. Yet I made my millions on the Internet. Funny, after 13 years of expensive institutional education, I NEVER took a formal class about the Internet or Web technologies. Heck, my computer classes were limited to introductory business courses. If I didn’t go to school to learn the Internet, how the heck did I learn and become educated within this skill set? I sought to change my oil frequently. I educated myself. I read books. I hit the library. I spent hours on the Web and read articles, tutorials, wikis. I sought and consumed knowledge.

Years ago, when I started my career with Internet media, I could have easily quit and leaned on the obvious: I don’t know how! I don’t know how to program a Web site! I don’t know how to design graphics! I don’t know how to manage a server! I don’t know how to write marketing copy! These excuses are like a plastic bag ready to smother your dreams, but only if you stick your head in the bag. Instead, my vision of a Web site didn’t end with “I don’t know how,” but started there. So, get your head out of the bag!

Had I not refreshed my skill set (my oil), my journey would have stalled. My religious pursuit of knowledge kept me efficient in an ever-changing world and primed me for Fastlane opportunities. Education didn’t end with graduation, it started. And best of all, my self-taught education was a twin-turbo acceleration into the Fastlane; my skills didn’t come loaded with parasitic debt or conformity.

EDUCATION IS FREELY AVAILABLE

The greatest travesty of the free world is the underuse of knowledge. Walk into your local bookstore and inhale. Smell that? That’s the smell of infinite knowledge. Walk into your local library and look around. Amazing. Wall-to-wall books, free for the taking. Imagine if you could digest every book, every paragraph, and every sentence. Would “I don’t know” be a detriment to your success?

I’m astonished that education is freely available, yet most choose not to take it. Education is unplucked fruit from a tree, and all it needs is a ladder. Yet, most people cling to the limiting belief that “I can’t afford education.” Sorry, but it’s an excuse to be lazy.